



Syllabus for Programming Fundamentals

Credits: 3

CS 1101

Instructor Contact Information:

You can always send your instructor a private message through the Brightspace Messaging system, accessible via the envelope (Messages) icon in the top navigation bar. Once logged into your course, click your instructor's profile page to see all the ways you can communicate with them, including their email address.

Course Description

This course provides beginners with a strong foundation in Python programming, covering variables, data types, control flow, functions, core data structures, libraries, and object-oriented concepts. It emphasizes moving from theory to practical application through Discussion Forums and Assignment Activities, enabling students to write, debug, and execute Python programs confidently. The course aims to foster problem-solving skills, inspire a passion for programming, and prepare students for advanced study in areas like data science, AI, or software development, in line with the institution's goal of producing adaptable, skilled graduates.

Learning Objectives

Program Learning Outcomes (PLOs):

1. Students will be able to provide a framework in applying strategies for the effective design of computing systems.
2. Students will be able to explain apply appropriate methods in the planning, development, and management of design projects.
3. Students will be able to cover the knowledge and skills needed to analyze problems from multiple perspectives and seek resolution through multiple methods and tools.
4. Students will be able to apply mathematics methods effectively to analyze and resolve problems.
5. Students will be able to communicate effectively using well organized arguments and credible supporting evidence.
6. Students will be able to enhance a command of critical thinking with respect to computer ethics, privacy, and security.

Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs):

1. Implement code using fundamental programming concepts, language constructs and procedural programming approaches.
2. Develop programs using the Python programming language including how they can be used to solve programming problems.
3. Examine programming languages and apply new programming language features.

Co/Prerequisites

None.

Course Materials

UoPeople courses use open educational resources (OER) and other materials specifically donated to the University with free permission for educational use. Therefore, students are not required to purchase any textbooks or sign up for any websites that have a cost associated with them. The main required textbook for this course is listed below and can be readily accessed using the provided links. There may be additional required/recommended readings, supplemental materials, or other resources and websites necessary for lessons; these will be provided for you in the course's General Information and Forums area, and throughout the term via the weekly course Unit areas.

- Mohbey, K. K., & Acharya, M. (2023). *Basics of Python programming: A quick guide for beginners*. Bentham Science Publishers.

To read this book:

- Log in to the UoPeople Library and navigate to [LIRN](#). Refer to the “[Tips for Searching LIRN](#)” section.
- Select Computer Science under the **Jump to the Specific Group** section.
- Search using the entire name of the book.
- View the online book.

Technology Requirements

To fully engage in this course and make the most of your learning,

- **PC Required:** A PC is recommended to ensure full compatibility with course tools and activities.
- **Internet Connection:** A stable internet connection is advised for seamless access to course materials and activities.
- **Browser:** For optimal performance and compatibility with course tools, please use an up-to-date browser.

Students must also have the ability to save documents and files. Typically, University of the People learning materials are provided to students in either Adobe PDF or Microsoft Office compatible formats. Therefore, students need to be able to open and save documents in these formats as well.

Additionally, the following specifications are desirable:

- **OS:** Microsoft Windows 11/10 or MacOS or Linux Operating system.
- **RAM:** A minimum of 8GB RAM, 16-32GB RAM preferred.
- **Storage:** SSD/HDD with a minimum capacity of 128 GB or more.

Software requirements:

- Python latest version
- Python IDE or code editor

Note: A Python Development Environment setup guideline is provided on the main course page.



Campus Tech Support

Please contact your Program Advisor, who is your primary point of support throughout your studies.

How to Contact Your Advisor

If you are unsure who your Program Advisor is, or if you need additional assistance, you may also contact the Program Advising team at advising@uopeople.edu.

Exam Technical Requirements & Support

To ensure maximum compatibility and reliability, it is highly recommended that you use the most recent version of Google Chrome or Mozilla Firefox when taking your exam. Furthermore, you should test the computer and browser ahead of time and ensure it has no technical issues that might hinder you during the exam period.

If you experience a technical problem during the exam, please contact your program advisor immediately.

Regular and Substantive Interaction

As your instructor, they will interact and engage with each of you on a regular basis throughout the term to support your learning. They will provide direct instruction related to the course's learning objectives, respond to your questions, grade and/or provide feedback on your submitted coursework, post regular announcements, and engage in the course discussion areas regarding academic course content when appropriate.

Course Expectations and Learning Activities

Discussions

Some units in this course require that you complete a Discussion Assignment. You are required to develop and post a substantive response to the Discussion Assignment in the Discussion Forum. A substantive response is one that fully answers the question that has been posed by the instructor. In addition, you must extend the discussion by responding to at least two (2) of your peers' postings in the Discussion Forum. Grading rubrics are provided in the Discussion Forum for each week. Discussion Forums are only active for each current and relevant learning week, so it is not possible to contribute to the forum once the learning week has come to an end.

Assignment Activities

The assignment activities are graded by your instructor. The grading rubric is listed under the assignment instructions. The grading rubric is a document that outlines the criteria that your instructor will use to grade your work.

Quizzes

This course will contain three types of quizzes – the Self-Quiz, the Graded Quiz, and the Review Quiz. These quizzes may contain multiple-choice, true/false, or short answer questions. The results of the Self-Quiz will not count towards your final grade. However, it is highly recommended that you complete the Self-Quiz to ensure that you have adequately understood the course materials. Along with the Reading Assignments, the results of the Self-Quiz should be used as part of an iterative learning process, to thoroughly cover and test your understanding of the course material. You should use the results of your Self-Quiz as a guide to go back and review relevant sections of the Reading Assignments. Likewise, the Review Quiz will not count towards your final grade but should also be used to assist you in a



comprehensive review and full understanding of all course material, in preparation for your Final Exam. Lastly, the results of the Graded Quizzes will count towards your final grade. Specific instructions on the format and content of the Graded Quizzes will be provided by your instructor.

Final Exam

The Final Exam will be available from Thursday through Sunday of Week/Unit 9, following the completion of eight units of work. The format of the Final Exam is similar to that of the quizzes and may contain a combination of different question types. You will have one attempt to take the exam, and it will be graded electronically. Specific instructions on how to prepare for and take the Final Exam will be provided during Week 8 (located inside the Unit 9). Final Exams must be taken without the use of course learning materials (both those inside and outside the course). If particular materials are allowed for use during the exam, these will be noted in the exam's instructions.

Class Introductions

This section is your opportunity to introduce yourself to your classmates and create a vibrant learning community. By sharing your background, interests, and goals, you can create meaningful connections and discover commonalities with your peers.

Course Forum

The Course Forum is the place to raise issues and questions relating to the course. It is regularly monitored by the instructors and is a good place to meet fellow students taking the same course. While it is not required to participate in the Course Forum, it is highly recommended.

Participation Expectations

- Be involved and active in your courses.
- Be highly motivated and disciplined.
- Check the course homepage, calendar and assignment page, the course syllabus, your UoPeople email, and the course discussion forums several times a week.
- Post the required comments and responses to the discussion forum for your course.
- Keep up with your assignments and online quizzes/exams (as applicable) and manage your time well. These quizzes test your knowledge and comprehension of the new content.
- Participate actively in class discussions.
- Be polite and respectful.
- Use good grammar and correct spelling.
- Be honest and original. Plagiarism will not be tolerated in any online course.

Non-participation is characterized by lack of any assignment submissions, inadequate contributions to the Discussion Forums, and/or lack of peer feedback to Discussion/Written Assignments. Also, please note the following important points about course participation:

- Assignments must be submitted on or before the specified deadline. A course timeline is provided in the course schedule, and the instructor will specify deadlines for each assignment.
- Occasionally there may be a legitimate reason for submitting an assignment late. Most of the time, late assignments will not be accepted and there will be no make-up assignments.
- All students are obligated to inform their instructor in advance of any known absences which may result in their non-participation.



Feedback and Suggestions

We value your input and would encourage you to complete the end of course survey to provide us with course feedback and suggestions, and report issues.

Evaluation and Grading Scale

Grading Weights:

Category	% Of Grade	Grade Items (Learning Activities)	Associated Learning Objectives/Outcomes
Discussions	30%	1. Unit 1 – Discussion Forum 2. Unit 3 – Discussion Forum 3. Unit 4 – Discussion Forum 4. Unit 6 – Discussion Forum 5. Unit 8 – Discussion Forum	• CLO 1, 2 • CLO 1, 2, 3 • CLO 1, 2 • CLO 1, 2, 3 • CLO 1, 2
Assignment Activities	40%	1. Unit 2 – Assignment Activity 2. Unit 4 – Assignment Activity 3. Unit 5 – Assignment Activity 4. Unit 7 – Assignment Activity	• CLO 1, 2, 3 • CLO 2, 3 • CLO 1, 2, 3 • CLO 1, 2, 3
Graded Quizzes	10%	1. Unit 3 – Graded Quiz 2. Unit 6 – Graded Quiz	• CLO 1, 2, 3 • CLO 1, 2, 3
Final Exam	20%	1. Unit 9 – Final Exam	• CLO 1, 2, 3
TOTAL 100%			

Grading Scale:

Letter Grade	% Grade	Grade Points
A+	98%-100%	4.00
A	93-97%	4.00
A-	90%-92%	3.67
B+	88%-89%	3.33
B	83%-87%	3.00
B-	80%-82%	2.67
C+	78%-79%	2.33
C	73%-77%	2.00
C-	70%-72%	1.67



Letter Grade	% Grade	Grade Points
D+	68-69%	1.33
D	63%-67%	1.00
D-	60%-62%	0.67
F	<60	0.00
W	N/A	N/A

Students may also be granted Withdrawal (W), if they withdraw from the course, or an Incomplete (I) should their circumstances permit. A student who feels they were graded unfairly, or who seeks to dispute a grade, may initiate a grade appeal process. Refer to [University Policies](#) for more information on withdrawals and appeals.

Course Schedule

UNIT 1: Introduction to Programming and Python Basics

- Watch/Read the reading assignments due by Saturday or Sunday.
- Discussion first response due by Sunday.
- Discussion replies due by Wednesday.
- Self-Quiz submission.

UNIT 2: Control Flow - Making Decisions

- Watch/Read the reading assignments due by Saturday or Sunday.
- Assignment Activity submission due by Wednesday.
- Self-Quiz submission.

UNIT 3: Control Flow - Loops and Iteration

- Watch/Read the reading assignments due by Saturday or Sunday.
- Discussion first response due by Sunday.
- Discussion replies due by Wednesday.
- Self-Quiz submission.
- Graded-Quiz submission due by Wednesday.

UNIT 4: Functions - Code Reusability

- Watch/Read the reading assignments due by Saturday or Sunday.
- Discussion first response due by Sunday.
- Discussion replies due by Wednesday.
- Assignment Activity submission due by Wednesday.
- Self-Quiz submission.

UNIT 5: Data Structures - Lists and Tuples

- Watch/Read the reading assignments due by Saturday or Sunday.
- Assignment Activity submission due by Wednesday.
- Self-Quiz submission.



UNIT 6: Data Structures - Dictionaries and Sets

- Watch/Read the reading assignments due by Saturday or Sunday.
- Discussion first response due by Sunday.
- Discussion replies due by Wednesday.
- Self-Quiz submission.
- Graded-Quiz submission due by Wednesday.

UNIT 7: Strings and File Handling

- Watch/Read the reading assignments due by Saturday or Sunday.
- Assignment Activity submission due by Wednesday.
- Self-Quiz submission.

UNIT 8: Introduction to Libraries and Object-Oriented Programming (OOP)

- Watch/Read the reading assignments due by Saturday or Sunday.
- Discussion first response due by Sunday.
- Discussion replies due by Wednesday.
- Self-Quiz submission.

UNIT 9: Final Exam

- Review Quiz submission.
- Final Exam due by Sunday.

University Policies & Processes

Late Work/Make-up Policy

Please review the [Late Work](#) policy in the University Catalog.

Code of Conduct

University of the People expects that students conduct themselves in a respectful, collaborative, and honest manner at all times. Harassment, threatening behavior, or deliberate embarrassment of others will not be permitted. Any conduct that interferes with the quality of the educational experience is not allowed and may result in disciplinary action, such as course failure, probation, suspension, or dismissal. For more information on this topic, please review the [General Code of Conduct](#) in the University Catalog.

Procedures for Resolving Academic Grievances/Appeals

If you believe that the final grade you received for a course is erroneous, unjust, or unfair, please contact your course instructor. This must be done within fourteen days of the last day of the term. For more information on this topic, please review the [Grievance Policy](#) and [Grade Appeals](#) Procedure in the University Catalog.

Withdrawal and Drop Date Policy

Please review the [Course Drops and Withdrawals](#) policy of the University Catalog.



Academic Integrity and Plagiarism

Plagiarism is a serious breach of academic trust. In academic work, our words and ideas are the value of our work, so turning in someone else's work as if it were your own is a form of theft. When you use someone else's words and ideas--whether it's the work of a famous writer or a fellow student--without crediting the source or authorship of those words and ideas, you are plagiarizing.

Please review the [Code of Academic Integrity](#) in the University catalog for more information.

Reference: Lee, C. (2019, April 4). *How to address Academic Integrity in your course syllabus*. Turnitin. <https://www.turnitin.com/blog/how-to-address-academic-integrity-in-your-course-syllabus>

Intellectual Property

UoPeople respects the intellectual property rights of others who seek to create, preserve, and disseminate knowledge through teaching, collective learning, and continued research at the University at large. For more information on this topic, please review the [Intellectual Property](#) policy in the University catalog.

Reasonable Accommodations

Contact your Program Advisor to open a request for support.

Student Support Services & Resources

English Programs

Academic Advising: advising@uopeople.edu

Financial Aid: financial.aid@uopeople.edu

Library Resources: library@uopeople.edu

Payment Processing: payments@uopeople.edu

Student Services: student.services@uopeople.edu

Technical Support: support@uopeople.edu